

# Prefect at the center of your pipelines

Prefect "Flows" are nice. WPipe "States" are better. 🌊💎

## The context

Prefect introduced a great way to handle workflows, but it often feels like you're building for the orchestrator rather than with your code. WPipe returns the control to the developer.

## Why engineers shift to wpipe

- Pure Python: No complex abstractions. Just your logic and the `@state` decorator.
- SQLite Checkpoints: Built-in persistence without external cloud dependencies.
- Parallel & Async: Native support for `Pipeline` and `PipelineAsync` with 100% parity.

### Code-first

Pipelines are Python: versionable, testable, reviewable in Git.

### Checkpoints

State persisted to SQLite WAL at every step; resume, don't restart.

### Independently lean

<50MB RAM. No broker, no daemon, no metadata server.

## What it looks like

```
from wpipe import Pipeline, step

@step(name="resumable", checkpoint=True)
def resumable(data):
    return {"state": hydrate(data["cursor"])}

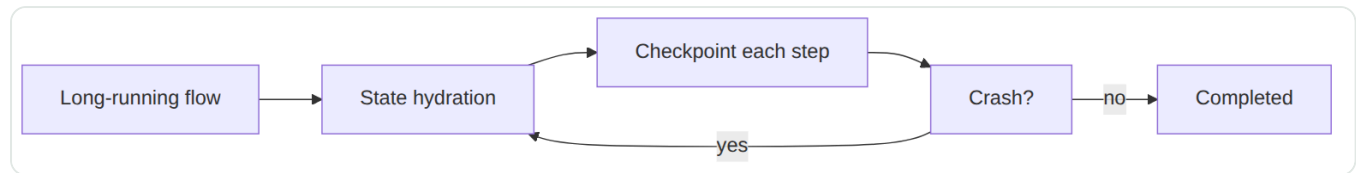
pipe = Pipeline(pipeline_name="resilient", tracking_db="state.db")
pipe.set_steps([resumable])
```

## At a glance

| Aspect        | Legacy / Prefect     | wpipe                   |
|---------------|----------------------|-------------------------|
| Definition    | Config/DSL or canvas | Python code             |
| State         | Scattered / none     | SQLite WAL checkpoints  |
| Observability | Partial              | Tracker SQL + dashboard |
| Footprint     | Heavy                | <50MB RAM               |

## Under the hood

The flow behind the post, as wpipe renders it from code.



#### +117k downloads

A community of efficiency-first developers.

#### <50MB RAM

Fits containers, VMs, and Raspberry Pi-class hardware.

#### SQLite WAL

Industrial durability without a database to administer.

## Next step

wpipe is a Python library — try it in your next pipeline:

```
pip install wpipe
```

Steps stay functions you already understand. Docs, diagrams, and dashboards follow. Explore **Prefect** workflows at [wpipe.readthedocs.io](https://wpipe.readthedocs.io).

wpipe · Python-native orchestration with SQLite WAL checkpoints, retries, timeouts, parallelism, and self-documenting flows. +117k downloads.